summer olympic games in Los Angeles along with other members of the Soviet bloc—a response to Jimmy Carter's removal of our team from the 1980 games in Moscow following the Soviet invasion of Afghanistan.

George Shultz worked hard, in meetings with Dobrynin and other Soviet officials, through the spring and summer of 1984 to reopen a U.S.-Soviet dialogue, but without much success. As I once observed in my diary that spring: "They are utterly stonewalling us."

Meanwhile, in Congress, Tip O'Neill said he had taken on a moral commitment to block further development of the MX missile, and this, I knew, wouldn't make it any easier for me to convince the Soviets that we were a united country committed to a policy of peace through strength.

Once again, a committee of 535 was trying to set foreign policy.

At the same time, opposition to our new strategic policy toward the Russians continued from small but well-organized and well-publicized antinuclear groups in Europe, and some European leaders, feeling the heat, began expressing doubts about NATO's 1979 decision to deploy the new weapons.

What would I think, I asked myself, if I were a Soviet leader and saw this kind of fractiousness among the leaders of the United States and the Western alliance? I'd try to exploit it, which is what they did. Seeing the split on our side, the Soviets intensified their propaganda offensive, trying to achieve political and military goals through a public relations campaign that blamed us for the impasse and claimed we were leading the world to the brink of nuclear war—when they had been the party who'd walked away at Geneva.

I asked George Shultz, without retreating in any way from our basic positions, to keep probing for the possibility of a summit.